PayFlowPro - 2026 Merchant Fee Handbook

Comprehensive 2026 Interchange Rate Tables and Statement Audit Guide

1. Executive Overview: Interchange-Plus vs Flat-Rate Pricing

Interchange-Plus pricing passes true wholesale card brand interchange costs through directly, supplemented by a fixed, transparent processor margin (e.g. +0.15% + $0.08 per transaction). Unlike blended flat rates (e.g. 2.9% + $0.30), interchange pricing preserves merchant profit margins by eliminating undisclosed non-qualified markups on debit and standard credit transactions.

2. 2026 Core Interchange Benchmark Schedules

* Visa Consumer Swiped/Tap Core Credit: 1.51% + $0.10
* Visa Regulated Debit (Durbin Amendment Cap): 0.05% + $0.21 + $0.01 fraud prevention
* Mastercard Merit III Retail Base: 1.58% + $0.10
* Mastercard Regulated Debit: 0.05% + $0.22
* Discover Retail Electronic: 1.56% + $0.10
* American Express OptBlue Wholesale Tier 1: 1.60% + $0.10
* Commercial / B2B Level 2 & Level 3: 1.85% + $0.10 (Requires Itemized Tax Data)

3. Statement Forensic Audit Checklist: 5 Hidden Junk Fees to Eliminate

[1] Tiered Downgrades: Non-Qualified surcharges ranging from 1.50% to 2.80% above base.
[2] Monthly PCI Non-Validation Fees: Penalties of $19.95 to $99.95 per MID per month.
[3] Batch Settlement Surcharges: Per-batch clearance fees exceeding $0.10.
[4] Inflated Gateway & Portal Surcharges: Markups exceeding standard $15-$25/mo gateway costs.
[5] Liquidated Damages & Early Termination: Cancellation penalties exceeding $295.

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To request your free 24-hour forensic statement audit, contact audit@payflowpro.com